of Gwynedd. He wanted the Perfeddwlad back.

Within the year, he had driven the English out of the Perfeddwlad. And his ambitions then expanded even farther, into the rest of Wales. He spent twenty years fighting: against the English outposts in Wales; against his fellow Welsh princes, forcing them to swear allegiance to him in place of the English king. Henry III, entangled in his bid for Sicily and his disputes with the barons, could not hold on to his Welsh claims or halt Llywelyn's advance. In 1267, five years before his death, Henry had been forced to recognize Llywelyn ap Gruffudd with a new title: Prince of Wales, the first Welsh ruler to claim anything more than local authority.*

Edward I intended to empty this title of its power and to reclaim the Perfeddwlad for himself. Three years after his accession, he ordered Llywelyn to travel to England and pay him homage. Llywelyn refused, and Edward prepared to march into Gwynedd.

It took him a year to raise an army and the needed funds, but a slew of English barons agreed to fight with him in exchange for gifts of conquered Welsh land. When fighting actually began, Llywelyn found the Welsh princes he had cajoled into submission melting away, happy to let the English king deal with their overbearing countryman. His own younger brother Dafydd, who had long hoped to get the lordship of Wales for himself, joined Edward's side. Edward, personally leading the campaign, cut Llywelyn off by land and hemmed him in by sea.[2]

By November 1277, Llywelyn was forced to agree to a peace treaty, the Treaty of Conway, that took away from him everything but his original small northwest corner of Gwynedd. Edward handed out Welsh lands to his barons in reward, took the Perfeddwlad for the crown, and gave Dafydd the rule over a chunk of the Gwynedd principality that had once belonged to his brother.

In five years, this arrangement fell apart. The English barons, as overlords to their Welsh tenants, were both dismissive and demanding; the English sheriff appointed to supervise Welsh affairs, Reginald de Gray, was harsh, dragging up decade-old offenses for trial and threatening petitioners with the death penalty; Dafydd himself was forced to obey English law in his own lands. "All Christians have laws and customs in their own lands," complained one Welsh nobleman. "Even the Jews in England have laws among the English; we had our immutable laws and customs in our lands, until the English took them away."[3]

Just before Easter 1282, Dafydd rallied the Welsh princes behind him. The first act of war was the sudden attack on an English-held castle, Hawarden, on the Saturday night before Palm Sunday. Within a week, Llywelyn had joined his brother (the English were now a greater threat than his sibling's